

GeoNews — Week 31/2026

A weekly digest on Quaternary palaeoclimate research, East African rift dynamics, palaeohydrology and time-series analysis · 2 August 2026

What is GeoNews? An **automatically generated weekly digest**. A research workflow screens the publications of the past one to two weeks along with funding, policy and community sources, scores the hits against a fixed set of criteria, and assembles this issue from the result.

The thematic profile is **aligned with the research interests of Markus L. Fischer** (Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam): Quaternary palaeoclimate and palaeoenvironmental reconstruction, the East African Rift, the African Humid Period and human-environment coupling, lake-level and water-balance modelling, palaeofloods and fluvial geomorphology, ICDP drill cores, and linear and nonlinear time-series analysis. Anyone working in these fields will probably find something useful here — it is explicitly not a complete survey of Quaternary science.

Selection, scoring and summaries are produced by machine and reviewed before publication. Details may contain errors; where in doubt, the linked original source governs.

Each paper receives a score from 0 to 100 across five criteria: thematic fit (40), methodological fit (25), impact/venue (15), applicability (10) and recency (10). Categories: ● 75 and above, must-read · ● 50–74, relevant · ● 30–49, on the radar. The score measures proximity to this newsletter's profile and sets reading priority; it is not a quality judgement on the individual paper.

In brief

Nine relevant papers, three on the radar, plus ten title-level records from the Elsevier core journals — again no must-read. Crossref access from the compute environment was blocked as in the previous week (proxy 403); the topic- and ISSN-based queries therefore ran entirely through the browser-based fetch interface and covered the same core journals as a normal run. The open-access Copernicus core journals (*Climate of the Past*, *Earth Surface Dynamics*, *Geochronology*) held no new, not-yet-listed papers in this window — the previous week had already drawn them down. The Elsevier titles again sit without abstract and without a score in a separate block.

Closest to the profile is a paper in *Communications Earth & Environment* on Holocene ecosystem variability and tipping points in the Eastern China Monsoon Region: the shrub layer buffers variability there, and potential transitions occur asynchronously across regions — relevant both thematically and, methodologically, through the question of tipping-point and early-warning signatures in multiproxy time series. Methodologically especially relevant is a paper in *The Holocene* that cleanly separates volcanic-seismic event signals from the climatic signature in an Antarctic lake core — the same core question of signal resolution in a single archive that is posed for rift lakes and in palaeoflood research. From the actual window come, further, a model-based paper on the mid-Holocene monsoon seasonality of the Thar Desert, a Central European loess-palaeosol study from Lower Austria (MIS 2) with explicit separation of local and higher-order signals, and a Mediterranean lagoon paper with Bayesian chronology and grain-size-based transport partitioning.

On funding the focus is unchanged: the Horizon palaeoclimate call **HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08** (opening 17 November 2026, deadline 4 March 2027), the **ERC Starting Grant 2027** (15 October 2026) and the **PAGES applications** (11 September 2026). Near-term: the **AGU abstract deadline on 5 August 2026**. On research policy the most important item of the week: the **federal cabinet adopted the WissZeitVG reform on 29 July 2026** — introducing, for the first time, binding minimum contract durations (three years for first contracts of doctoral researchers, two years for postdocs) and a maximum fixed-term duration in the postdoc phase standardised at six years. The Bundestag is next in line.

Part A — Papers of the week

Papers were captured with a  or online date from 19 July 2026 onwards. DOIs already listed in the issues of 20 July and 27 July are excluded. Every scored entry in the  and  categories rests on an abstract that was inspected; the closing  block lists papers from the Elsevier core journals for which no abstract was accessible — without a score and without any claim about their content. There is no  must-read this week.

Relevant (50-74)

1. Shrub-mediated vertical coupling regulates Holocene ecosystem variability and transition dynamics · *Communications Earth & Environment*, 2026 · **Score 74** A multiproxy analysis (pollen, charcoal, palaeoclimate and human-activity proxies) from the Eastern China Monsoon Region across the Holocene, examining how vertical vegetation structure — tree, shrub and herb layers — regulates ecosystem variability and potential tipping points. Central finding: in northern temperate forest-grassland mosaics and southern subtropical forests, shrubs are associated with reduced variability — consistent with a buffering that maintains continuity between canopy and ground layers. In the more open, warm-temperate central region this buffering is weak, and lower variability there depends mainly on a closed woody framework; potential tipping points are asynchronous, with earlier transitions in the structurally weaker central region. Doubly relevant here: the theme of ecosystem variability and tipping points in the Holocene on one hand, and methodologically the identification of transitions and early-warning signatures in multiproxy time series on the other — the same question addressed for the AHP termination using tipping-point and early-warning methods. *Theme 25 · Method 20 · Venue 11 · Applicability 8 · Recency 10* (created 29 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1038/s43247-026-03877-2](https://doi.org/10.1038/s43247-026-03877-2)

2. Decoupling climate and volcanic-seismic signals from the periglacial Jurasee Lake at King George Island (South Shetland Islands, Antarctica) for the Middle-to-Late Holocene · *The Holocene*, 2026 · **Score 71** A sediment core from the periglacial Jurasee Lake on King George Island, spanning the middle to late Holocene (890 ± 30 to 4870 ± 50 cal a BP). Volcanic-seismic processes on Deception Island — up to a caldera collapse on the scale of the largest of the past several millennia — are strongly expressed in the region. The work combines XRF scanning, X-ray diffraction, magnetic susceptibility and sedimentation rates to separate the volcanic-seismic inputs from the climatic-sedimentary signal component in the lake sediment. Methodologically the most interesting paper of the week for this profile: decoupling non-climatic event signals from the underlying climatic signature in a lake core is the same core question posed for rift lake sediments and in palaeoflood research — how to cleanly resolve superimposed signal sources in a single archive. *Theme 25 · Method 20 · Venue 8 · Applicability 8 · Recency 10* (created 29 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1177/09596836261468297](https://doi.org/10.1177/09596836261468297)

3. Patterns and seasonality in the mid-Holocene hydroclimate of the Thar Desert in northwestern India · *Communications Earth & Environment*, 2026 · **Score 69** A model-based investigation of the seasonality of mid-Holocene precipitation in the Thar Desert (northwest India) using the multi-model simulations of PMIP4, linked to the question of spatial moisture distribution and its coupling to the Indus cultural transformation. Finding: the models agree with proxy data on a strengthened summer monsoon across the Thar in the mid-Holocene, with the north receiving about double the effective moisture of the south — synchronous with the spread of agriculture alongside continued foraging. Stronger winter-rain changes in the south explain, per the paper, part of the spatial heterogeneity. Relevant as a clean example of model-data integration on monsoon seasonality and of human-environment coupling at an arid monsoon margin — conceptually transferable to East African monsoon and AHP contexts. *Theme 25* · *Method 15* · *Venue 11* · *Applicability 8* · *Recency 10* (created 28 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1038/s43247-026-03857-6](https://doi.org/10.1038/s43247-026-03857-6)

4. A multiproxy approach to address signals of MIS 2 climate fluctuations using loess-palaeosol sequences along a slope transect at Langenlois (lower Austria) · *Quaternary Research*, 2026 · **Score 69** Loess-palaeosol sequences at three closely spaced sites along a slope transect near Langenlois (Lower Austria) across Marine Isotope Stage 2 (MIS 2). A stated objective is to disentangle the pedosedimentary influence of local slope processes from regional to global climate change, and thereby assess the reconstruction potential of the profiles. High-resolution colour, grain-size and geochemical analyses capture local depositional dynamics and identify weak pedogenic signals that are macroscopically hard to distinguish in the field; luminescence dating and relative stratigraphy provide the chronological framework. The results indicate, among other things, a pronounced landscape transition out of tundra conditions. Relevant as a Central European Quaternary archive with a clean separation of local and higher-order signals — precisely the methodological question that is also central to interpreting lake-sediment and palaeoflood archives. *Theme 25* · *Method 18* · *Venue 8* · *Applicability 8* · *Recency 10* (created 29 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1017/qua.2026.10097](https://doi.org/10.1017/qua.2026.10097)

5. Sedimentary archives of Mediterranean climate variability: grain-size signatures in Halk El Menjel Lagoon during the late Holocene · *The Holocene*, 2026 · **Score 67** A late-Holocene sedimentary archive (HK2) from Halk El Menjel Lagoon in the south-central Mediterranean (Tunisia), spanning about 4400 years. The chronology rests on three new AMS radiocarbon dates integrated into a Bayesian age-depth model (rBchron). Grain-size analysis of 750 samples identifies twelve subpopulations, grouped by principal component and distribution analysis into three transport modes — aeolian (600–1000 µm), fluvial (250–580 µm) and hydraulic runoff. Relevant less for the region than for the methodology: Bayesian age-depth modelling plus grain-size end-member separation of transport processes is exactly the toolbox applied to lake sediments. *Theme 25* · *Method 20* · *Venue 8* · *Applicability 8* · *Recency 6* (created 21 Jul 2026) · DOI: [10.1177/09596836261450777](https://doi.org/10.1177/09596836261450777)

6. Subfossil Coleoptera as palaeoecological indicators of environmental conditions during the Neolithic: Serteya II site, NW Russia · *The Holocene*, 2026 · **Score 65** The first reconstruction of shore-zone evolution of the Great Serteya Palaeolake Basin (Western Dvina Lakeland, NW Russia) based on subfossil Coleoptera (beetles), embedded in long-running geoarchaeological study of a Neolithic lakeshore settlement. From the beetle assemblages the authors infer marsh and fully aquatic phases as well as periods of highly variable lake level for the interval around 5.45–3.78 ka cal BP, coupled to climatically driven water-level fluctuations and the hydrological regime of the Serteyka River. Relevant as a proxy-based reconstruction of lake-level and shore dynamics in the context of prehistoric settlement — the same coupling of

water balance and human–environment relations that is at issue in East African lake contexts.

Theme 25 · Method 14 · Venue 8 · Applicability 8 · Recency 10 (created 29 Jul 2026) · DOI: 10.1177/09596836261450819

7. Extreme Events Reshape Flood Hazards Through Sediment-Induced Channel Change in Southern Taiwan · *Geophysical Research Letters*, 2026 · **Score 63** An investigation of how extreme precipitation events alter flood hazards over the long term via sediment-induced channel change, using Typhoon Morakot (2009) across four catchments in southern Taiwan. Morakot triggered over 17,000 landslides, delivering large volumes of sediment to steep mountain rivers and reducing channel conveyance. Pre- and post-event digital elevation models were built from aerial imagery and Structure-from-Motion photogrammetry, and inundation was simulated with HEC-RAS 2D. Result: sediment-driven channel infilling increased inundation area by up to 44 percent, while reaches with little sediment supply showed thalweg erosion and reduced inundation. A recent event, but methodologically directly relevant to palaeoflood research: sediment supply modulates flood impact — a process analogue for interpreting fluvial extreme-event archives. *Theme 25 · Method 15 · Venue 11 · Applicability 6 · Recency 6 (created 25 Jul 2026) · DOI: 10.1029/2026GL122788*

8. Dispersal, source and glass chemistry of a third tephra unit within Iceland's Settlement Layer · *Boreas*, 2026 · **Score 63** A description of a previously undocumented, dark-grey tephra unit within the Icelandic Settlement Layer (AD ~877), one of Iceland's most important isochron markers. Electron-probe micro-analyses identify the unit as a bimodal transitional alkali basalt; it was deposited less than a year before the Vatnaöldur unit. Relevant as a tephrochronology paper: precisely characterised ash layers are isochronous time markers that provide exactly the framework on which age–depth models in lake-sediment and soil archives are anchored. *Theme 25 · Method 14 · Venue 8 · Applicability 6 · Recency 10 (created 26 Jul 2026) · DOI: 10.1111/bor.70079*

9. Holocene sea-surface temperature as a regional driver of environmental shifts and its effects on humans of La Paz Bay, Gulf of California · *The Holocene*, 2026 · **Score 62** A reconstruction of Holocene summer sea-surface temperatures (SST) of La Paz Bay (Baja California Sur, Mexico) from $\delta^{18}\text{O}$ in shells of *Pinctada mazatlanica*, obtained from a ^{14}C -dated Holocene coastal camp. Over the last ca. 8.4 ka the $\delta^{18}\text{O}$ values vary; individual time slices (including 6936 and 2093 cal a BP) indicate markedly colder SST, and periods of low SST coincide with arid, periods of high SST with more humid conditions — with reference to the local human communities. Relevant as a shell-based isotope SST reconstruction with coupled SST–aridity–human relations. *Theme 25 · Method 13 · Venue 8 · Applicability 6 · Recency 10 (created 31 Jul 2026) · DOI: 10.1177/09596836261468260*

● On the radar

- **Simulating the impact of an AMOC weakening on the Antarctic Ice Sheet using a coupled climate and ice-sheet model** · *Earth System Dynamics* · **48** ● · A coupled climate–ice-sheet model simulates how an AMOC weakening propagates warm anomalies toward Antarctica via inter-hemispheric heat redistribution and influences the Antarctic Ice Sheet; both are classified as tipping elements. Relevant methodologically through the tipping-point theme. DOI: [10.5194/esd-17-1025-2026](https://doi.org/10.5194/esd-17-1025-2026)
- **ICE-NADI-1: A new deglacial ice sheet thickness history (25–1 ka) for North America** · *EGUsphere (preprint)* · **42** ● · $\triangle$ *Preprint* · An empirically constrained deglacial ice-sheet reconstruction for North America in 500-year steps, with implications for sea level and glacial-

isostatic adjustment; noted as a reconstruction/modelling architecture at the edge of the profile. DOI: [10.5194/egusphere-2026-4374](https://doi.org/10.5194/egusphere-2026-4374)

- **Predictability of European summer climate: the influence of competing mechanisms related to Atlantic Multidecadal Variability** · *Earth System Dynamics* · 41 ● · A model-ensemble study on the predictability of European summer climate and the role of Atlantic Multidecadal Variability; noted as a dynamics- and predictability-methods paper at the edge of the profile. DOI: [10.5194/esd-17-1007-2026](https://doi.org/10.5194/esd-17-1007-2026)

◦ Screened without an abstract — Elsevier core journals

These ten papers come from the Elsevier journals in the profile and fall inside the window. Crossref records them with title, journal, DOI and created date, but deposits no abstracts for Elsevier; ScienceDirect is not retrievable from this compute environment, and the articles are days old and not yet in search indices. They are therefore listed **without a score and without content annotation** — the note states only the thematic connection that follows from the title. What the papers actually say is decided by the full text.

Palaeohydrology and lake sediments

- **Holocene hydroclimate events recorded by Mg-calcite and protodolomite in Lake Balaton (Hungary)** · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, created 30 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: Holocene hydroclimate events in a Central European shallow lake, resolved through carbonate mineralogy. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110186](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110186)
- **Hydroclimatic trend and millennial abruptions in southwestern China since the last deglaciation** · *Global and Planetary Change*, created 28 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: hydroclimatic trend and millennial-scale abrupt events since the last deglaciation. DOI: [10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105639](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105639)
- **Differential organic matter accumulation and preservation in the Quaternary** · *Global and Planetary Change*, created 29 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: differential accumulation and preservation of organic matter in Quaternary sediments. DOI: [10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105638](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105638)

Monsoon, teleconnection and abrupt events

- **Indian monsoon regulates the sediment supply of the Upper Yangtze River since ~2 Ma** · *Earth and Planetary Science Letters*, created 31 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: monsoon control on sediment supply over the Quaternary (source-to-sink). DOI: [10.1016/j.epsl.2026.120266](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.epsl.2026.120266)
- **North Atlantic linkage to hydroclimatic weakening in the NW Himalaya during the 4.2 ka event** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology*, created 31 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: North Atlantic teleconnection to the 4.2 ka event in a Himalayan archive. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114101](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114101)
- **Two-stage pattern of Dansgaard-Oeschger 19.2 during MIS 4: evidence from a high-resolution record** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology*, created 29 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: high-resolution structure of a Dansgaard-Oeschger event in MIS 4. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114102](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114102)

Fluvial, glacial and event deposits

- **Fluvial aggradation in Japan during MIS 5d-2: a chronological synthesis and new insights** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology*, created 29 Jul 2026 · Thematic

link per title: fluvial aggradation and its chronology across several isotope stages. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114104](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114104)

- **Holocene glacier fluctuations at Eklutna Lake, Chugach Mountains, south-central Alaska** · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, created 31 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: Holocene glacier fluctuations reconstructed from a proglacial lake archive. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110107](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110107)
- **Fingerprinting paleotsunami deposits using sedimentary biomarkers — a succinct review** · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, created 26 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: biomarker-based identification of palaeotsunami deposits — event-deposit diagnostics. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110188](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110188)

Quantitative palaeotemperature

- **Late Glacial coleopteran Mutual Climatic Range temperature reconstructions from three sites** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology*, created 30 Jul 2026 · Thematic link per title: quantitative palaeotemperature reconstruction via the Mutual Climatic Range method on beetles. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114096](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114096)

Part B — Funding & calls

Horizon Europe — "Palaeoclimate science for a better understanding of Earth system dynamics" (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08). Opening **17 November 2026**, deadline **4 March 2027**, Research and Innovation Action, budget around **€14 million for roughly two projects**, so about €7 million per consortium. The stated aim is robust information on palaeoclimate states and events outside the range of variability recorded over the past centuries, to guide the development of Earth system models. With two funded projects Europe-wide the competition is severe, and consortium discussions belong early in the timeline. Sources: [topic page](#) · [CL5 Work Programme 2026–2027 \(PDF\)](#).

ERC Starting Grant 2027 — deadline 15 October 2026. Step 1 results in April 2027, interviews and Step 2 results in August 2027. Eligibility: PhD defended no more than ten years before 1 January 2027, extendable for parental and care leave. New from the 2027 calls: at most one Starting and one Consolidator Grant per career, plus stricter application rules. The **ERC Consolidator 2027** is expected in January 2027. Sources: [ERC — Applying in the 2027 competitions](#) · [ERC — Changes to the 2026 and 2027 Work Programmes](#).

PAGES — working group and workshop support, deadline 11 September 2026. The next application round covers workshops, meetings, new working groups and extensions of existing groups. Ahead of the Horizon palaeoclimate call this is a convenient instrument for forming a visible consortium. Also: the **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027**, applications close **29 September 2026**. Sources: [PAGES — Workshop/meeting support](#) · [PAGES Newsletter July 2026](#).

ICDP — proposal cycle. The regular annual deadline for full, pre- and workshop proposals is **15 January**; the 2027 cycle is likely to follow the same pattern, though no formal announcement has appeared. Workshop calls run through the year. Source: [ICDP — Proposals](#).

DFG — changed conditions. No new palaeoclimate-specific call. Relevant for planning: the **programme allowance rises from 22 to 25 percent from 2027**; the next **Priority Programme application round** takes place only in **late 2026**, with funding starting in **2028**. Source: [Forschung & Lehre](#).

Part C — Research policy (Germany/EU)

WissZeitVG — reform adopted by cabinet on 29 July 2026. New since the previous week: the federal cabinet adopted the bill to modernise fixed-term employment law in science on 29 July 2026; the May ministry draft was revised in part after criticism from scientific associations. Its core is, for the first time, binding **minimum contract durations: three years for first contracts of doctoral researchers, two years for postdocs**; the maximum fixed-term duration in the postdoc phase is **standardised at six years**. The bill does not require Bundesrat approval; dates for the deliberations in the Bundestag and Bundesrat are not yet set. As interpretation rather than fact: minimum durations improve the predictability of early contracts, while the removal of earlier carry-over provisions further narrows individual fixed-term planning in the postdoc phase — anyone carrying unused time should watch the further parliamentary path. Sources: [BMFTR — cabinet adopts amendment to the WissZeitVG](#) · [Federal Government — better working conditions in science](#) · [Forschung & Lehre — government takes up associations' criticism](#) · [Wiarda blog — decided, but provisional](#).

Federal budget 2027 — cabinet decision of 6 July 2026, Bundestag to follow in autumn. The government draft has stood since 6 July 2026. The research ministry's (BMFTR) core budget stands at around **€22 billion** — a nominal increase of only about **0.7 percent** over 2026. Real increases come almost exclusively from the special fund for infrastructure and climate neutrality, whose R&D investments rise by roughly 60 percent in 2027 over 2026. The parliamentary deliberation (first reading) is due in autumn. As interpretation: the regular budget stagnates in real terms given current pay and materials cost increases, keeping the funding organisations under operational pressure. Sources: [Forschung & Lehre — only a slim increase for the BMFTR core budget](#) · [Table.Briefings — Budget 2027](#).

DFG cuts at the postdoc level. Facing high collective-agreement pay rises and increased equipment and consumables costs that the guaranteed annual funding increments do not cover, the DFG has postponed the funding start for new Research Training Group applications and **suspended approval of postdoc positions**. For postdoc career paths in the geosciences this removes one funding route for the time being, increasing pressure on individual grants and EU money. Source: [Fakultätentag Informatik](#).

Part D — Community & deadlines

- **AGU Fall Meeting 2026 — 7–11 December 2026 in San Francisco**; abstract deadline **5 August 2026** (23:59 EDT). Source: [AGU](#).
- **PAGES working group and workshop applications — 11 September 2026** · **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027 — 29 September 2026**.
- **DEUQUA conference 2026 — 28 September to 2 October 2026 in Freiburg im Breisgau**, with full-day excursions on 28 September and 2 October. Source: [DEUQUA](#).
- **ERC Starting Grant 2027** — deadline **15 October 2026**.
- **Horizon CL5 palaeoclimate call** — opening **17 November 2026**, deadline **4 March 2027**.
- **EGU General Assembly 2027 — 4 to 9 April 2027 in Vienna**, hybrid. The abstract deadline is not yet published; experience suggests mid-January. Source: [EGU](#).
- **ICDP** — next regular proposal deadline expected **15 January 2027**, following previous years' pattern and not yet confirmed.

Method & sources

Paper screening uses the Crossref REST API with topic- and ISSN-based queries and the `from-created-date` filter. DOIs already listed in an earlier issue are not repeated. Funding, research policy and deadlines rest on the sources linked in Parts B to D.

How this issue came about. Crossref access from the compute environment was blocked by a proxy 403, as in the previous week. The queries therefore ran entirely through the browser-based fetch interface — topic- and ISSN-based across the core journals (QSR, EPSL, GPC, P³, Boreas, JQS, Quaternary Research, Communications Earth & Environment, Nature Geoscience, The Holocene, GRL) and the Copernicus layer (Climate of the Past, Earth Surface Dynamics, Geochronology, Earth System Dynamics and EGU sphere preprints via the Copernicus member index). The three open-access Copernicus core journals of the profile held no new, not-already-listed papers in this window; their current issues had been covered the week before. One missing Crossref abstract (Communications Earth & Environment) was supplemented from the open OpenAlex index and treated as such.

What remains open. Elsevier deposits no abstracts with Crossref. The usual workaround via the publisher page was unavailable: ScienceDirect responds to this environment with a bot check, and the papers are days old and not yet indexed. Rather than inferring results from titles, those ten papers sit in a separate, clearly marked block without a score and without any claim about their content. For the scored entries the standard is unchanged: every substantive statement rests on an abstract that was inspected; preprints are flagged as such.

Note on the week number. This run falls on Sunday 2 August 2026 — the closing day of ISO calendar week 31, in which the previous issue (Monday, 27 July) also appeared. Both issues therefore carry the same week number; they are distinguished by their issue date.

GeoNews is an automatically generated digest published by Dr Markus L. Fischer, Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam. The thematic profile follows his research interests; selection is made by a rule-based workflow, not an editorial team. The digest is an independent literature review with no affiliation to the publishers or funding bodies mentioned, and does not constitute a recommendation or advice. Corrections and pointers are welcome.